

Working Title: Creek Whatchaknow (What-You-Know)

Theme: Love

Premise: Love can bring true selflessness.

Conceptual Model: The Discovery

Synopsis: Kevin and Richard are partners in crime, committing bank heists. After a heist gone wrong, Kevin escapes to the safehouse without knowing that Richard was captured by the police. Given an ultimatum, make sure Kevin dies or face life in prison, Richard is sent to kill Kevin at the hideout with a wire. After Richard gets there, they talk about meeting at a summer camp for delinquent boys as kids. They reminisce about their dream to finally live on Creek Watchaknow. Kevin finds out that Richard was sent there to kill him and holds him at gunpoint. Richard begs him to leave with him, that he finds a way out, but Kevin ignores him and heads to where the police are stationed outside of the sewers. There, he sacrifices himself for Richard's freedom.

Genre: Tragedy/Crime

Setting: Chicago's sewer system in the 1980s. Claustrophobic, foul-smelling, and always dripping with moisture. A hideout set up among the pipes. A few fold-out chairs and an ice box with some beer inside, as well as some sleeping bags.

Character Profiles:

Character's name: Kevin Zhan

Age: 23

Physical Dimensions:

Prominent physical characteristics: He is six feet and two inches tall.

Attire/distinctive objects: He wears glasses.

Distinctive speech patterns/mannerisms: He tends to curse to accentuate his points or when he's particularly frustrated.

Physical Constraints: He is farsighted without his glasses, meaning he can only focus on things in the distance.

Psychological dimension:

Personality/Predisposition: Chummy. A dreamer who looks out for others more than himself.

Wants: To live a peaceful and quiet life on Creek Whatchaknow with Richard.

Needs: Personal security and a place to live, as the police are hunting him.

Ways of coping with stress/obstacles: Internalizing it and venting it through his crimes.

Attitudes towards new situations: Flexible and able to adapt.

Sociological dimension:

Class: Lower Class

Race and ethnicity: Asian, Chinese-American

Education: Dropped out before graduating from High School.

Family/friends: His best and only friend, Richard.

His parents disowned him and kicked him out of the house when he was 17 years old.

The only family member he misses is his little sister, who, at the time he was evicted, was 5 years old.

Talents/Hobbies: Great at lockpicking, good communication skills, and wood carving.

Character's Arc:

Kevin is pessimistic that either he or Richard can live a peaceful life after the police are on his tail.

Kevin feels betrayed when he finds out that Richard has been asked to kill him, and he threatens to kill Richard.

Kevin understands that his friend doesn't truly want to kill him and that he only wants the same peace he is looking for, so he sacrifices himself for Richard.

Viewpoint Character

Character's name: Richard Aro

Age: 22

Physical Dimensions:

Prominent physical characteristics: He is five feet and seven inches tall.

Attire/distinctive objects: He wears glasses.

Distinctive speech patterns/mannerisms: He speaks softly and avoids swearing.

Physical Constraints: He is near-sighted without his glasses.

Psychological dimension:

Personality/Predisposition: Reserved but opens up with the right people. Tends to prioritize himself over others unconsciously.

Wants: To live a peaceful life at any cost.

Needs: To have a dependable person to rely on and to live with.

Ways of coping with stress/obstacles: Burying his face into a book or biting his nails.

Attitudes towards new situations: Cautious and calculated, doesn't want to go into anything without a plan.

Sociological dimension:

Class: Upper Middle Class

Race and ethnicity: Black, Chilean-American

Education: Dropped out before graduating from High School.

Family/friends: Best and only friend, Kevin.

His father died in a car accident when he was seven years old, and his mother died of cancer when he was eighteen years old.

Talents/Hobbies:

Good at calculating financials. Heist planner. Reads science fiction novels.

Character's Arc:

Richard is initially compelled to kill Kevin by the police officers for his freedom.

After reminiscing with Kevin, he is reminded of their special bond and changes his mind.

Richard is shocked by Kevin's sacrifice and now has to live with the burden of his choices.

The Menu for Richard Aro:

What I Love:

- Sci-Fi novels from William Gibson and David Brin.
- The feeling of a plan well executed.
- The feeling of being a vigilante, fighting for the common man.
- The feeling of Kevin's presence, the only peace I have left.
- A calm night without any action.

What I Hate:

- The way delinquent children are treated as broken goods.
- That the financial system in America can't support its people.
- The feeling of running out of options.
- The idea of hurting someone I love.
- Sleepless nights thinking of what could happen.

What I Fear:

- That I may never rest.
- That I could be left with nothing after all this effort.
- That I am selfish, only putting on the façade of someone who cares for others.
- That Kevin knows I'd pick me over him if it came down to it.
- That I was doomed from the day I became a criminal to a life of even more pain and hardship.

What I Believe:

- Capital needs to be redistributed to the masses.
- Kevin and I are justified in what we do.
- Turning myself in to the police would be the death of me.
- Kevin and I were destined to be together.
- What we have done will not be in vain.

What I Value:

- Peace and Security.
- The respect of the common people.
- Someone's ability to get things done efficiently.
- Selflessness.
- Strength and determination.

What I Know About:

- The floor plans of every major bank in Chicago.
- How to wire money through offshore accounts.
- What it is like to lose the people keeping you tethered.
- The feeling of always having to look over your shoulder.
- How easy it is to give up your morals for self-interest.

People Who Made a Difference in My Life:

- My Mother, who encouraged me to read.

- My father, who taught me how to manage money.
- My Uncle, who taught me that I had to protect myself first.
- A Camp Counselor, for helping to create me and Kevin's signal.
- Kevin, who helped me achieve my dream of peace.

Discoveries That Made a Difference in My Life:

- That society wasn't going to accept me back in.
- Finding much money each year is stolen through wage theft.
- I can make a positive difference in the world.
- True selflessness is real.
- Kevin is more selfless than I am.

Decisions That Made a Difference in My Life:

- My decision to live a life of crime.
- My decision to start committing petty crime at thirteen years old.
- My decision to bunk with Kevin at summer camp.
- My decision to leave high school after the death of my mother.
- My decision to betray Kevin instead of facing life in prison.

7 Steps:

Once upon a time, Richard became partners in crime with Kevin.

And every day, they would plan and execute daring heists.

Until one day, Richard is captured by the police while Kevin escapes after a heist gone wrong.

Because of this, Richard is pressured to kill Kevin for his own freedom.

Because of that, Richard confronts Kevin at their hideout, and Kevin finds out that he plans to kill him.

Until finally, Richard is given freedom by Kevin's sacrifice.

And ever since that day, Richard has borne the weight of his betrayal.